EKATERINA DEYS

Payment Success at Sokin — my first 90 days

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This plan is written from the outside, based on the job description and how cross-border B2B payments usually break. I would treat every point as a hypothesis, test it against Sokin's data in the first two weeks, and rewrite the plan with the team. The goal stays the same: more payments go straight through, and clients always know where their money is.

HOW I WOULD MEASURE PAYMENT SUCCESS

Metric	Why it matters
Straight-through processing rate	Share of payments that complete with no manual repair or client follow-up. The headline number for the role.
First-time submission success	Payments rejected at creation or by a partner show where rules or validation are missing.
Repairs and manual touches per 1,000 payments	The operations cost of every gap in the rules.
Status-related tickets per 1,000 payments	"Where is my payment?" questions measure how good tracking really is.
Time to final status, by corridor	Speed clients feel; the base for honest ETAs.

DAYS 1–30 · LEARN AND SET THE BASELINE

Outcome: one shared picture of where payments fail and what each failure costs.

- Map the payment lifecycle end to end: creation and rules, validation, routing, submission to partners, confirmation, tracking, returns.
- Build a failure taxonomy from transaction-level data: rejections by rule, partner, corridor, currency and reason code. Size each bucket in payments, money and ops hours.
- Sit with Operations, Support and Compliance on real repairs and tickets; learn which checks exist for regulatory reasons and must stay.
- Agree baseline metrics and one dashboard the tribe trusts; ship 2–3 quick wins (clearer validation messages, missing pre-checks on beneficiary data).

DAYS 31–60 · FIX THE BIGGEST LEAKS

Outcome: the top three failure buckets measurably smaller.

- Move checks to payment creation: corridor-specific beneficiary and purpose-code rules, so bad payments are fixed by the client before submission instead of repaired by Ops after.
- One internal payment state model with clear reason codes, mapped from every partner's responses. At inDrive this single model is what made outcomes consistent for finance and support.
- Client-facing tracking built on that model: plain-language status, the reason when something is held, and the next step.
- Partner health monitoring and alerts (backlogs, timeouts, reject spikes), so degradation is caught before clients notice.

DAYS 61–90 · MAKE IT SCALE AND PREPARE THE ML BETS

Outcome: a platform regional teams can build on, and a ranked roadmap for H1.

- Routing and fallback rules per corridor by success, speed and cost, with a clear owner and change process.
- Pick the first ML use case by data readiness and value. Likely candidates from the JD: failure prediction before submission, delivery-time prediction for ETAs, routing decisions. Start with one pilot and a clear success metric.
- A monthly payment success review with Engineering, Ops and Compliance, plus a roadmap that balances fixes, platform work and expansion needs.

WHAT I BRING TO THIS

- **Routing, failover and provider health:** payment orchestration across 40 countries at inDrive, cost-based routing (~$100K/month saved), failover on soft/hard declines, 96.4% provider SLA.
- **Correct, auditable money movement:** disbursements with idempotency, retries and reconciliation; PSP, EMI and bank integration contracts with error mapping (SkyRo).
- **Compliance as a partner:** led PCI DSS Service Provider certification with Security and Compliance.

Questions I would bring to the first week: which corridors carry most volume and most repairs; where STP is lost today (creation, partner rejects or returns); how repairs are handled now; which partner signals we already capture. Most of my hands-on experience is with card and PSP flows; cross-border rails and local schemes are where I would invest time first.